FRANCISCO SANTOS

Game Designer // Gameplay Programmer // 3D Artist

Leiria, Portugal

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Portfolio · 3D Portfolio · Sketchfab

Internship: 15 Feb – 29 May 2027 · 640 h · Erasmus+

// TOOLS

ENGINES
Unreal Engine 5 · Unity

3D / ART
Blender · Photoshop · After Effects

DESIGN / AUDIO
Figma · FL Studio · Twine

PRODUCTION
Trello / Jira

// CORE COMPETENCIES

DESIGN
Horror Systems & Tension Design · Gameplay · Systems · Narrative · Quest · Level · UX/UI

PROGRAMMING
Gameplay Programming · AI Behaviour Trees · UE5 Blueprints · C# (Unity) · Rapid Prototyping

PRODUCTION
Leadership · Cross-functional Collaboration · Agile / Scrum

// LANGUAGES

Portuguese – Native
English – C2

// EDUCATION

Kajaani UAS, Finland
Erasmus · Game Design & Development

Polytechnic Institute of Leiria
Games and Multimedia (ESTG)

LSD
Game Design Course

2D/3D Animation
3-year secondary course

Online Courses
Rigging, Modelling, GameDev, Programming

// ACHIEVEMENTS

Global Game Jam
Participant & Winner, multiple editions

RUN European University
Games that can be Heard with the Eyes: accessible, intergenerational design for hearing inclusion

Leadership Academy
Multi-day programme on ethical leadership, teamwork and communication

// PROFILE

Game Designer and Gameplay Programmer specialising in horror systems and tension design: sanity, AI behaviour and atmosphere. Comfortable across the whole 3D pipeline in Blender, so I can take an idea from mechanic to modelled, rigged and playable. Experienced in leading international student teams and building complete Unreal Engine prototypes from concept to playable demo.

// 3D ART · FULL PIPELINE

Comfortable across the whole Blender pipeline, from concept to game-ready asset, with a stylised, atmospheric look.

MODELLING · TEXTURING · RIGGING · ANIMATION · UE5 / UNITY EXPORT

Selected work: The Developer (horror character), Wizard's Laboratory (low-poly environment), Royale Mashine, a product-ad visual and game-ready props, published on Sketchfab as unifasDev.

Backed by a 3-year 2D/3D Animation course and two dedicated rigging courses.

// EXPERIENCE

ERASMUS EXCHANGE · KAJAANI UAS

FINLAND · 2026

Game Design & Development, Kajaani University of Applied Sciences

- Delivered multiple working game prototypes per semester in a high-pressure, high-output environment.
- Lead programmer on 'Once Upon a Page', a 3D narrative game built by an international team.

// PROJECTS

ONE LAST SCORE

UE5 · BLENDER · 2026

First-person stealth-horror demo · Solo developer · Final class project

- Stealth-horror set in a cursed Victorian manor with a compounding risk loop: Explore → Loot → Manage Weight & Sanity → Evade Entity → Escape.
- Engineered a sanity system that alters AI entity behaviour: the more the player pushes their luck, the more aggressive and unpredictable the threat becomes.
- Implemented a three-stage weight/greed mechanic: heavier loot slows movement, forcing a risk/reward decision on every pickup.
- Scripted a full AI Behaviour Tree (patrol, pressure, tracker, cooldown) that reacts to player sanity in real time.

CUSTOM ENGINE & HORROR GAME

IN DEVELOPMENT

Solo developer · Horror systems R&D

- Building a custom engine and horror game to prototype tension systems: dynamic lighting, audio, pacing, environmental events and player uncertainty, plus smaller prototypes to test and iterate on each idea.

ONCE UPON A PAGE

UNITY · KAJAANI · 2026

3D narrative game · Lead programmer · Team project

- Led all programming: core game systems, player interactions and narrative progression mechanics.
- Coordinated with international designers and artists to deliver a polished playable demo under tight deadlines.

TRAPPED WITH IT

UE5 · BLENDER · 2024

Psychological horror · Solo developer

- Built a suspenseful procedural horror forest through environmental design and soundscapes.
- Designed phobia-based challenges that make psychological tension a core gameplay pillar.
- Implemented complex AI with unpredictable, escalating encounters.

DAWNBREAKER

UE5 · 2024

Melee action RPG · Solo developer

- Designed a fluid melee combat system with impactful feel, and boss encounters with unique per-boss mechanics.
- Composed and integrated an original soundtrack and SFX in FL Studio.

ASTRALON: ALIEN ASSAULT

UE5 · BLENDER · 2024

Space combat · Solo developer

- Built dynamic space combat with AI behaviour, player controls and interactive UI.
- Implemented UE5 rendering and physics simulation, plus performance optimisation.